

Word family: **address / addresses / addressed / addressing / addressee / addressable / unaddressed**

Base word: address

Forms: addresses, addressed, addressing

Related forms: addressee, addressable, unaddressed

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “...it conceals a deeper problem that Hong Kong should **address** properly.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **address** means **to deal with a problem, issue, need, or situation seriously and take action to improve or resolve it**.

繁體中文： **處理；正視；着手解決某個問題、需要或情況**

中文翻譯：

> “...a deeper problem that Hong Kong should **address** properly.”

「.....一個香港應該好好**正視並處理 / 着手解決**的更深層問題。」

Here:

address a problem = 正式面對並採取行動處理問題，而不只是提及它

1. **address = deal with a problem, issue, need, or concern (問題) — 處理；正視；應對**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To give serious attention to a problem, issue, need, question, or concern and take steps to deal with it.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Hong Kong needs to **address** the shortage of suitable study space.”

「香港需要**正視並處理**合適學習空間不足的問題。」

Practice 2

> “The new policy aims to **address** housing problems.”

「新政策旨在**處理 / 應對**住房問題。」

Practice 3

> “We need to **address** the underlying cause, not just the symptoms.”

「我們需要**處理**根本原因，而不只是表面症狀。」

address = 對某個問題、需要或疑慮作出認真處理，通常暗示採取實際行動

Common:

- * address a problem
- * address an issue
- * address a concern
- * address a need
- * address a challenge
- * address inequality

2. **address** = speak directly to a person or group (說話) — 向……說話；對……發言

Address can mean to speak directly to someone, especially formally.

Practice 4

> “The principal **addressed** the students.”

「校長向學生**講話 / 發言**。」

Practice 5

> “She **addressed** the audience in a calm voice.”

「她用平靜的聲音向觀眾**發言**。」

address someone = 正式或直接地向某人 / 某群體說話

Common:

- * address an audience
- * address a meeting
- * address the public

* address the nation

This is a major distinct verb sense.

3. **address = give a formal speech to an audience (演說) — 發表演說 ; 致辭**

Closely related to #2, but often more specifically:

> **address an audience / conference / assembly**

= give a formal speech.

Practice 6

> “The scientist **addressed** the conference.”

「那位科學家在會議上**發表演說**。」

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 rather than create a separate core meaning.

4. **address = use a particular name/title when speaking to someone (稱呼) — 稱呼**

Address can mean to call someone by a particular name, title, rank, etc.

Practice 7

> “How should I **address** the professor?”

「我應該怎樣**稱呼**那位教授？」

Practice 8

> “She prefers to be **addressed as** Dr Lee.”

「她希望別人**稱呼她為**李博士。」

address someone as X = 用某個名字、稱號或職銜稱呼某人

This is a genuinely distinct verb branch.

5. **address = write the recipient's location/details on mail (郵件) — 寫上地址 ; 註明收件人**

Address can mean writing a recipient's name and destination on a letter, parcel, envelope, etc.

Practice 9

> "Please **address** the envelope clearly."

「請在信封上清楚**寫上收件地址**。」

Practice 10

> "The package was **addressed to** me."

「這個包裹是**寄給我的 / 寫着我的收件資料**。」

address mail to someone = 在郵件上寫明收件人和送達資料

This is a major practical verb sense.

6. **address = direct a message/document specifically to someone (針對 / 致予) — 致 ; 寫給 ; 向.....提出**

The mail sense extends beyond physical envelopes.

Practice 11

> "The letter was **addressed to** the manager."

「這封信是**寫給 / 致**經理的。」

Practice 12

> "His remarks were **addressed to** younger employees."

「他的話主要是**對年輕員工說的**。」

be addressed to someone = 某個訊息、評論、文件等以某人為特定接收對象

This bridges the speech and recipient senses.

7. **address = noun: location where someone lives/works (地址) — 地址**

This is one of the principal noun meanings.

Practice 13

> “What is your home **address**?”

「你的住址是甚麼？」

Practice 14

> “Please enter your delivery **address**.”

「請輸入你的送貨**地址**。」

****address = 用來識別某個住宅、公司或地點位置的資料****

Common:

- * home address
- * postal address
- * business address
- * delivery address
- * return address

8. ****address = electronic destination/identifier (科技) — 電子地址 ; 位址****

Modern technology has several highly established ****address**** uses.

**email address**

> “Please send it to my email address.”

= 電郵地址

**web address**

> website URL / 網址

**IP address**

> 網際網路協定地址

**memory address**

> 電腦記憶體中某個位置的位址

Practice 15

> “Every device on the network has an IP **address**.”

「網絡上的每部裝置都有一個 IP **位址**。」

Practice 16

> “The program stores the value at a specific memory **address**.”

「程式把數值儲存在特定的記憶體**位址**。」

address = 在通訊、網絡或電腦系統中，用來識別某個目的地、裝置、帳戶或資料位置的標識

This is a major technical branch.

9. **address** = noun: formal speech (演說) — 演說；致辭

As a noun, **an address** can mean a formal speech.

Practice 17

> “The president gave a televised **address**.”

「總統發表了一次電視**演說**。」

Practice 18

> “Her opening **address** lasted twenty minutes.”

「她的開幕**致辭**持續了二十分鐘。」

an address = 向觀眾、公眾或正式集會發表的演說

This is the noun counterpart of Meaning 2.

10. **address** = form/manner of calling someone (稱謂) — 稱呼方式；稱謂

In expressions such as:

> **form of address**

address refers to the way someone is formally called.

Practice 19

> “‘Your Honour’ is a formal form of **address** in certain courts.”

「在某些法庭場合，‘Your Honour’ 是正式的**稱謂**。」

form of address = 用來稱呼某人的正式 / 社交名稱或稱謂

This belongs to the naming/title branch.

11. **address** = devote attention to a subject in speech/writing (論述) — 談及；探討；針對

A speech, book, report, article, etc. can **address** a topic.

Practice 20

> “The report **addresses** several ethical questions.”

「這份報告**探討 / 處理**了幾個倫理問題。」

Practice 21

> “The book **addresses** the relationship between technology and society.”

「這本書**探討**科技與社會之間的關係。」

Here **address** may mean:

- * discuss seriously;
- * deal with conceptually;
- * direct attention toward.

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but unlike **solve a problem**, the object may simply be a topic or question.

For strict counting, I would merge it with #1 under:

> **turn serious attention toward something**

while noting that not every **address a topic** implies solving it.

12. **address = golf: position yourself and club before hitting the ball (高爾夫) — 擺好擊球姿勢；瞄球**

In golf, **address the ball** means to take up the stance and position from which you intend to hit it.

Practice 22

> “She **addressed the ball** carefully before the shot.”

「她擊球前仔細**站好姿勢並瞄準球**。」

address the ball = 擺好身體和球桿位置，準備擊球

This is a genuine specialist verb sense and should be retained in a comprehensive audit.

13. **address oneself to something = turn one’s attention/effort to it (正式) — 着手；專心處理**

A formal construction:

Practice 23

> “We must now **address ourselves to** the main question.”

「我們現在必須**着手處理 / 集中討論**主要問題。」

Practice 24

> “She addressed herself to the task.”

「她開始**專心處理**那項工作。」

address oneself to something = 把注意力和努力集中到某事上

This is formal and less common than simply:

> address the problem

> turn to the task

It belongs to Meaning 1.

Related form: **addressee**

An **addressee** is the person to whom a letter, message, speech, etc. is addressed.

Practice 25

> “The name of the **addressee** was missing.”

「信上沒有寫**收件人**的姓名。」

addressee = 訊息、郵件或說話所指向的接收者 / 收件人

This is a useful family form.

Related form: **addressable**

Addressable has several established uses.

capable of being dealt with (可處理的)

> “The problem is addressable.”

「這個問題是**可以處理 / 可以解決的**。」

computing/electronics: individually identifiable/controlable (可定址的)

> “Each unit is individually addressable.”

「每個單元都可以**獨立定址 / 識別**。」

This is particularly important in:

- * computing
- * memory systems
- * networks
- * digital displays
- * electronics

Related form: ****unaddressed****

****Unaddressed**** has two especially important branches.

****problem not dealt with****

Practice 26

> “The underlying problem remains ****unaddressed****.”

「根本問題仍然****沒有得到處理****。」

****mail without a destination written on it****

> “an unaddressed envelope”

「沒有寫地址的信封」

Same form, two branches reflecting the two major meanings of ****address****.

Related noun: ****addressing****

In technology, ****addressing**** can mean the system/process of assigning or using addresses.

Examples:

- * IP addressing
- * memory addressing
- * network addressing

****addressing = 定址 ; 地址分配 / 識別方式****

This is a useful technical nominalization.

Important distinction: ****address vs deal with****

For problems:

****deal with****

is broad and everyday.

address

is somewhat more formal and often suggests:

- * recognizing the issue;
- * directing serious attention to it;
- * taking deliberate action.

- > deal with a complaint
- > address a structural problem

Your editorial deliberately uses **address** because it sounds more policy-oriented and serious.

Important distinction: **address vs solve**

address

= take action to deal with a problem.

solve

= successfully find the answer or remove the problem.

You can **address** a problem without completely solving it.

This distinction is very important.

Important distinction: **address vs discuss**

discuss

means talk/write about something.

address

can mean discuss it seriously and directly, often with the aim of responding to it.

- > discuss housing
- > address the housing shortage

The second is more action-oriented.

Important distinction: ****address vs tackle****

****tackle****

means actively attempt to deal with a difficult problem.

****address****

is more formal and slightly broader.

> tackle crime

> address crime

Both can work; ****tackle**** sounds more forceful.

Important distinction: ****address vs speak to****

****speak to someone****

is ordinary.

****address someone****

is more formal and often implies speaking to them directly as an audience or recipient.

> speak to a friend

> address an audience

Important distinction: ****address vs call****

For names/titles:

****call someone X****

ordinary:

> "Call me Sam."

****address someone as X****

more formal:

> "Please address her as Professor Chan."

Important distinction: **address vs location**

location

means where something is physically situated.

address

is the identifying set of information used to locate/deliver to it.

> location: northern Hong Kong

> address: street number + street + district, etc.

Important distinction: **address vs residence**

residence

means the place where someone lives.

address

means the identifying information for that place.

Your residence has an address.

Grammar note: **address + object directly**

For the main verb senses:

> address a problem

> address an audience

> address a letter

No preposition is needed between **address** and the object.

Grammar note: ****address something to someone****

For mail/messages:

- > address the letter to Ms Wong
- > comments addressed to parents

Grammar note: ****address someone as + title****

- > address her as Professor Lee
- > address him as Sir

Countability note

****Address**** is countable in its main noun senses.

Location

- > an address
- > several addresses

Speech

- > an address
- > three formal addresses

Computing

- > an IP address
- > memory addresses

Pronunciation note

There is regional variation.

In American English, the noun often has first-syllable stress:

- > ****AD-dress****

while the verb normally has second-syllable stress:

> ****ad-DRESS****

In British English, second-syllable stress is common for both.

This pronunciation difference is useful, but it does not change the semantic mapping.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* ****address****
* ****addresses****
* ****addressed****
* ****addressing****
* ****addressee****
* ****addressable****
* ****unaddressed****

The full sweep gives several genuine semantic clusters:

1. ****identify a destination/location****
2. ****speak to someone****
3. ****deal with/direct attention to a subject or problem****
4. ****call someone by a name/title****
5. ****technical identifier/location****
6. ****specialist golf use****

These should be separated where the mental concept changes, while constructions such as ****address a report topic**** and ****address a problem**** can be merged conservatively under deliberate attention/dealing.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
address — deal with issue	正視並採取行動處理某個問題、需要、疑慮或議題
address — topic in speech/writing	正面談及 / 探討某個主題或問題
address — speak to someone/group	正式或直接向某人 / 某群體說話、發言
address someone as X	用某個名字、稱號或職銜稱呼某人
address mail	在郵件、包裹等寫明收件人和送達資料
address — physical location noun	用來識別住宅、公司或地點所在位置的地址

address — digital/computing	識別電郵帳戶、網站、裝置、網絡或記憶體位置的位址 / 地址	
address — speech noun	向觀眾或正式場合發表的演說 / 致辭	
form of address	稱呼某人的方式 / 正式稱謂	
address the ball — golf	擺好站姿和球桿，準備擊球	
addressee	收件人 / 訊息的接收對象	
addressable	可以處理的；科技中亦指可獨立定址 / 識別的	
unaddressed	尚未處理的；或沒有寫地址的	

For your original sentence

> “...a deeper problem that Hong Kong should **address** properly.”

The exact meaning is:

address = 正式承認這個更深層的問題，認真處理它，並採取合適措施改善或解決它

So:

> **address the problem properly**

= **妥善正視並處理這個問題**

This is **not identical to `solve`**. The sentence says Hong Kong needs to confront and act on the structural lack of study space; whether it can completely solve the problem is a further question.

For your database, I would count **6 genuinely useful core meanings** for **address**:

1. **deal with / direct serious attention to a problem, need, topic, or concern**
2. **speak formally/directly to someone or an audience**
3. **call someone by a particular name/title**
4. **write/direct mail or a message to a recipient**
5. **noun — location/destination identifier, including digital/computing addresses**
6. **noun — formal speech/address**

I would keep **address the ball** as a legitimate lower-priority golf sense, treat computing addressing as an important domain extension of #5, and keep **addressee / addressable / unaddressed** as family extensions.